during the 1971 war, and for her support for the Green Revolution, which allowed India to become self-reliant in food production. She also made contributions to India's conservation policies (including overseeing the launch of Project Tiger), approved India's first nuclear test explosion in Pokhran in 1972 (which made India officially a nuclear power) and oversaw the establishment of the Indian Space Research Organisation.



Indira and her Congress were defeated in the 1977 elections, and the Janata Party, which included many of Indira's opponents, formed the government. Indira's old rival Morarji Desai was appointed prime minister but his government did not last its full term.

LEADERS OF FREE INDIA

The three men on these pages, who had different backgrounds and divergent views on politics and economics, led modern India through some of the most eventful periods in its history.